

ART AND CULTURE



LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE

IMPORTANT REGIONAL LITERATURE

MODULE – 7



REGIONAL LITERATURE

KANNADA LITERATURE



It is said that Kavirajamarga was inspired by or composed in parts by Rashtrakuta king Amogavarsha I

- 1 The Kannada literature can be divided into 3 phases, old (450-1200 CE), middle (1200 to 1700 CE), and modern (1700 CE onwards) and its literary characteristics are categorized as **Jain, Veerashaiva and Vaishnava** —recognizing the prominence of these three faiths.
- 2 Starting with the Kavirajamarga, considered to be the earliest of Kannada literature and until the middle of the 12th century, literature in Kannada was almost exclusively composed by the **Jains**, who found eager patrons in the **Chalukya, Ganga, Rashtrakuta, Hoysala**.

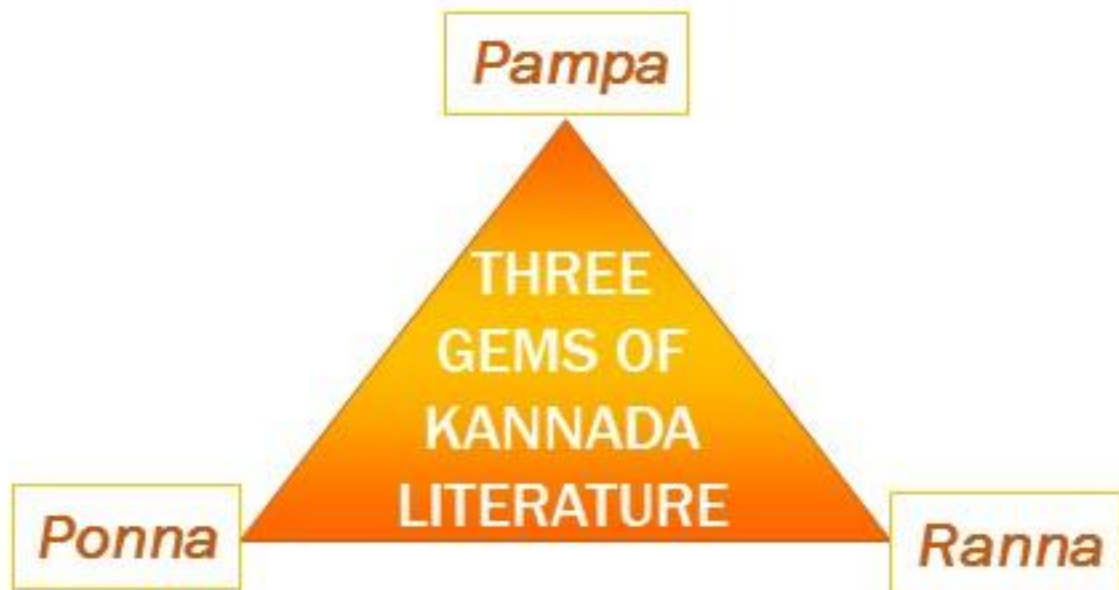
REGIONAL LITERATURE

KANNADA LITERATURE

- 3 The **Veerashaiva movement** of the 12th century created new literature which flourished alongside the Jain works.
- 4 With the waning of Jain influence during the **14th-century Vijayanagara empire**, a new **Vaishnava literature** grew rapidly in the 15th century; the devotional movement of the Haridasa saints marked the high point of this era.
- 5 Close to the 17th century, Kannada literature move towards **spoken and sung folk tradition with musicality** being its hallmark.
- 6 The reign of the imperial **Rashtrakutas and the Gangas**, marks the beginning of the **classical period of writings in the Kannada language** under royal patronage, and the end of the age of Sanskrit epics.
- 7 There was an emphasis on the **adoption of Sanskritic models while retaining elements of local literary traditions**, a style that prevailed in Kannada literature throughout the classical period.
- 8 **Kavirajamarga**, written during this period, is a treatise on the Kannada speaking people, their poetry and their language.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

KANNADA LITERATURE



9 The works of Jain writers **Adikavi Pampa**, **Sri Ponna** and **Ranna**, collectively called the "three gems of Kannada literature", heralded the age of classical Kannada in the 10th century.

10 It is also in the tenth century that **Pampa**, better known as the 'father of Kannada' wrote two of his greatest poetic works, **Adipurana** and **Vikramarjuna Vijaya**.

11 The second gem or **Ponna** has written a famous treatise, titled **Shanti Purana** and the third gem, **Ranna** has authored **Ajitanatha Purana**.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

KANNADA LITERATURE

- 12** Interaction between Kannada and Telugu literatures and translations of classics from Kannada to Telugu and vice versa became popular.



- 13** Well-known bilingual poets of this period were Bhima Kavi, Piduparti Somanatha and Nilakanthacharya.
- 14** In fact, so well versed in Kannada were some Telugu poets, including Dhurjati, that they freely used many Kannada terms in their Telugu writings.
- 15** This process of interaction between the two languages continued into the 19th century in the form of translations by bilingual writers.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

KANNADA LITERATURE



16 The development of modern Kannada literature can be traced to the early 19th century when Maharaja Krishnaraja Wodeyar III and his court poets moved toward prose renderings of Sanskrit epics and plays.

17 Kempu Narayana's *Mudramanjusha* ("Seal Casket", 1823) is the first modern novel written in Kannada.

18 Among the post modern Kannada writers of acclaim are

- Vinayaka Krishna Gokak (Jnanpith and Padma Shri Awardee),
- U.R. Anantamurthy (Sahitya Akdemi, Jnanpith and Padma Shri Awardee),
- K.V.P Kuvempu (Sahitya Akademi and Padma Vibhushan Awardee) and
- M.V. Iyengar (Jnanpith Awardee)

REGIONAL LITERATURE

BENGALI LITERATURE

Earliest Bengali literature can be traced to the Charyapads/Charyageet, a collection of Buddhist mystic songs dating back to the 10th and 11th centuries.

- 1 The timeline of Bengali literature is divided into two periods – medieval (1360-1800) and modern (after 1800).



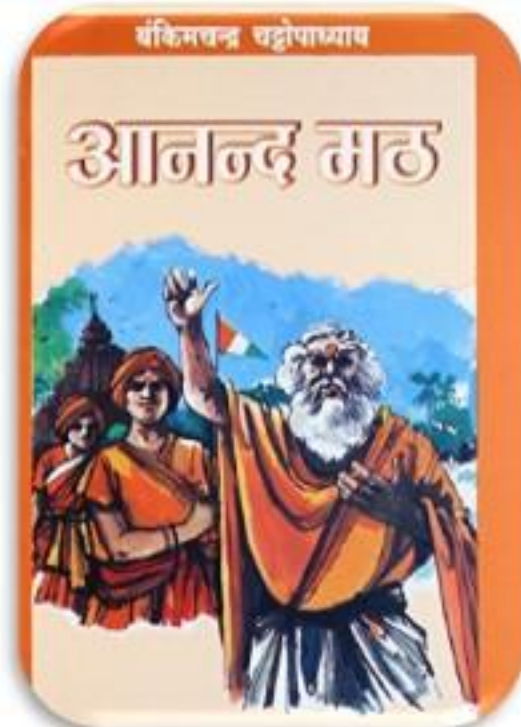
- 2 Pre-Chaitanya or Early Vaishnava literature denotes the literature of the time preceding the time of **Chaitanya Mahaprabhu**, the founder of Gaudiya Vaishnavism.

- 3 The 15th century is marked by the emergence of Vaishnava lyrical poetry. The **first major Bengali poet to write Vaishnava lyrics** was Chandidas.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

BENGALI LITERATURE

- 4 It was with the nationalist fervour reaching Bengal that the literature took a definite turn towards the concerns of the common man's suffering and the nation's plight under the British rule.

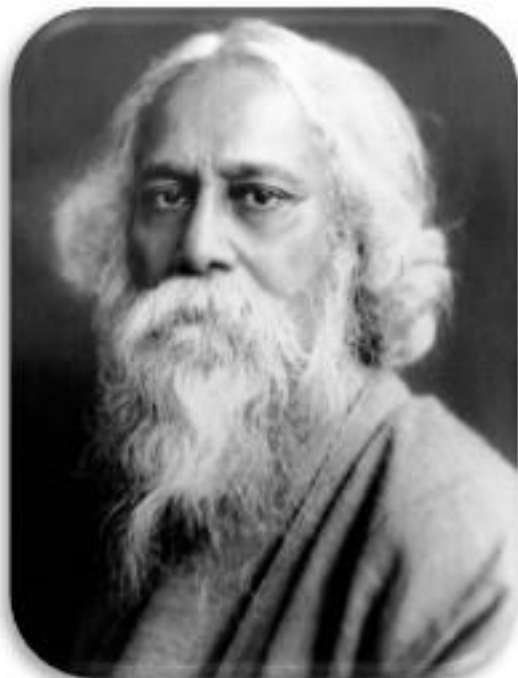


- 5 Raja Ram Mohan Roy was amongst the first to write in Bengali and English and his work was read widely.
- 6 His contemporary writers were Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar and Akshay Kumar Dutta.
- 7 But the zenith of nationalist Bengali literature was achieved by the writing of Bankim Chandra Chatterjee. His work Anand Math was hugely popular, so much so that Vande Mataram, our national song, is an excerpt taken from this novel.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

BENGALI LITERATURE

- 8 Possibly the most prolific writer in Bengali is Nobel laureate Rabindranath Tagore. Tagore dominated both the Bengali and Indian philosophical and literary scene for decades.



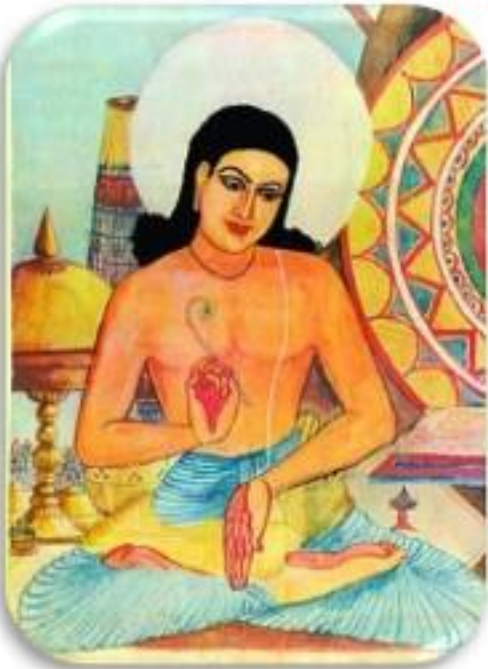
Rabindranath Tagore

- 9 He received Nobel Prize for literature (1913) for his collection of poems 'Geetanjali'. He also composed the songs adopted as national anthems of India and of Bangladesh.

- 10 Other important litterateurs are:
- Dinabandu Mitra- Nil Darpan
 - Michael Madhusudhanan Dutt- Meghnadh Bodh Kabyo; introduced the blank verse poetry style.
 - Sharat Chandra Chatterjee, Qazi Nazrul Islam and Romesh Chandra Dutta made important contributions to Bengali literature.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

ASSAMESE LITERATURE



Sankardev inspired the Bhakti movement in Assam. He is widely credited with building on past cultural relics and devising new forms of music (Borgeet), theatrical performance (Ankia Naat, Bhaona), dance (Sattriya), literary language (Brajavali).

1 In the medieval period, Assamese literature was dominated by **buranjis** (court/historical chronicles). Apart from these official works, **Shankardev** composed devotional poetry in Assamese.

2 These include works of Shankar Deva like **Kirtana-ghosha**, **Harishchandra-Upakhyana**, etc. Other important litterateurs of this period include Madhavdev, Damodardev, etc.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

ASSAMESE LITERATURE



Hemchandra Barua



**Lakshminath
Bezbaruah**

3

Modern literature:

- Hemchandra Barua, Lakshminath Bezbaruah, and Hemchandra Goswami were important contributors to modern Assamese literature.
- Another prominent litterateurs of the 20th century is **Rajnikanta Bordoloi** (novelist and journalist).

REGIONAL LITERATURE

ODIA LITERATURE



**Fakirmohana
Senapati**

- 1 From the east of India, a sizeable corpus comes from Odia literature. The first work came from **Sarala Das**.
- 2 The medieval Oriya Literature was inspired by Bhakti movement particularly **Chaitanya's Vaishnaism**.
- 3 The 19th century saw three great Oriya poets in Radhanatha Ray, Madhusudan Rao and Fakiramohana Senapati. **Fakiramohana Senapati** was a novelist and poet who contributed significantly to Odia literature in the 19th Century.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

GUJARATI LITERATURE



Narsinh Mehta

- 1 As mentioned earlier Bhakti movement was at its peak in Gujarat and that affected the literature composed there.

- 2 Narsinh Mehta is a very popular name in this area as he combined devotional songs for Lord Krishna with local folk traditions.

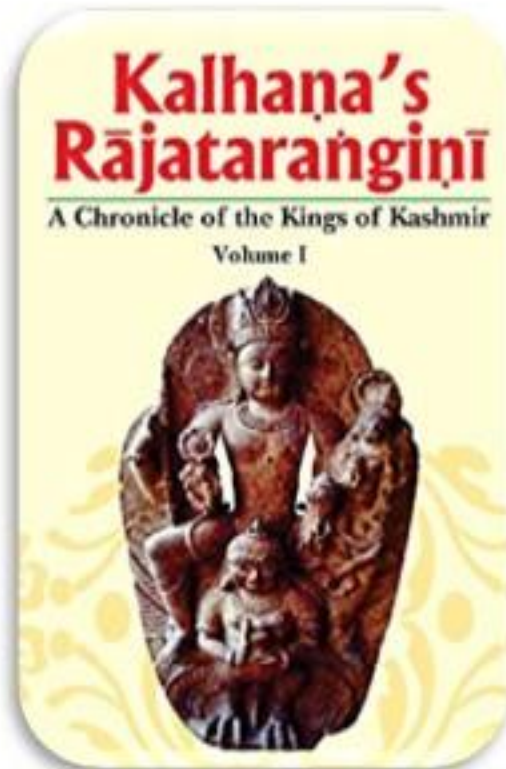
- 3 The later period saw poetry by Narmad and prose by Govardhan Ram who wrote the classic Gujarati novel, Saraswati Chandra, which has been made into a television series recently.

- 4 The pinnacle of success in Gujarati literature was achieved by Dr K.M Munshi who has written fiction and non-fiction (historical) work too.

- 5 One of his finest novels is Prithvi Vallabha.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

KASHMIRI LITERATURE



- 1 Kashmiri is among the oldest languages of India tracing its origin to as early as the 5th to 6th century CE.

- 2 In the course of evolution, it has been influenced by a variety of languages such as Sanskrit, Tibetan, Hindi, Persian and Dogri, etc.
- 3 Kalhana's Rajatarangini is the oldest Kashmiri Literature (12th century CE).
- 4 The local people used Kashmiri and it had influences from Persian and Hindi dialects.
- 5 In the early medieval period when the Bhakti movement was at its peak, Kashmiri language saw its first female poetess called Lal Ded, who was a Shaivite mystic.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

KASHMIRI LITERATURE



The pyramid-shaped Habba Khatoon mountain was named after her.

- 6** In the Medieval period, Habba Khatoon (poet and ascetic), whose is also called as “Nightingale of Kashmir”.

- 7** But the major spread happened after the coming of Islam and Sufism to Kashmir and several major writers like Sufi Ghulam Muhammad, Zinda Kaul, Mahjoor, etc
- 8** Another interesting person in Kashmiri literature is Noor Din who was also known as Nand Rishi and was purported to bring the Hindi and Islamic elements together in his poetry.
- 9** With the political power passing to the Dogra family in Jammu in 1846, Kashmiri has been eclipsed by Dogri language.
- 10** Recently, some interest has again begun in reviving the language.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

MARATHI LITERATURE



Saint Jnaneshwar

- 1 Although we categorise it as the Marathi language, there are several dialects in Maharashtra and the literature is composed in all of them.

- 2 The oldest known work in Marathi is from the 13th century by **Saint Jnaneshwar** (also known as Gyaneshwar).
- 3 He is credited to begin the kirtan in Maharashtra and has written a detailed **commentary on the Bhagvata Gita in Marathi**.
- 4 **Namdev**, the **Bhakti saint and contemporary of Jnaneshwar** is the other significant literary figure from this era. Namdev composed religious songs in Marathi as well as Hindi; some of his Hindi compositions are included in the Sikh holy book, the **Guru Granth Sahib**.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

MARATHI LITERATURE



Eknath on a 2003 stamp of India

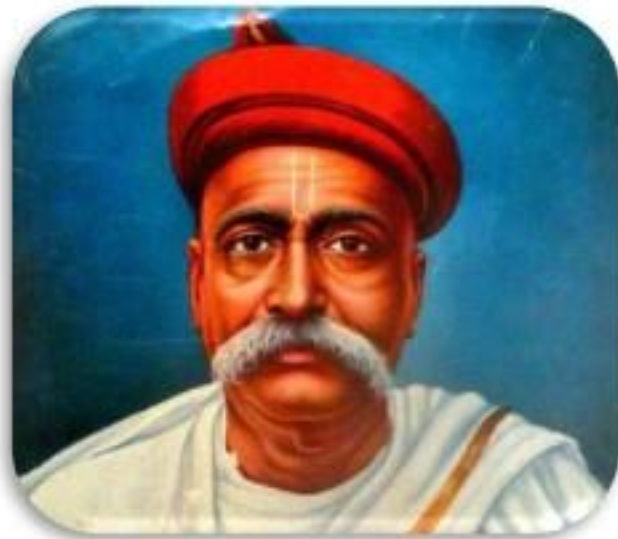
5 But the most famous saint from Maharashtra from the sixteenth century was **Eknath** who wrote **commentaries on Bhagwata Purana and Ramayana** and as he also composed works in the vernacular language.

6 With the beginning of journalism in the 19th century, a number of personalities associated with social reforms and freedom movement contributed to the **national cause through Marathi journalism and literature**. This includes

- Jyotiba Phule (Deenbandhu; a journal),
- Balgangadhar tilak (newspaper; Kesari) and
- Gopal Krishna Gokhale (newspaper; Sudharak).

REGIONAL LITERATURE

MARATHI LITERATURE



Bal Gangadhar Tilak

- 7** Tukaram and Ramdas are the other notable Bhakti poets.

- 8** The nationalist movement affected the Marathi poetry and prose writing too.
- 9** One of our greatest nationalistic figures, Bal Gangadhar Tilak, published his regional news paper **Kesari** in Marathi.
- 10** This paper criticised the British and their policies and published tracts by leading revolutionaries of that time.
- 11** Marathi prose writing took a turn for the better with the works of Hari Narayan Apte and V.S. Chiplunkar.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

PUNJABI LITERATURE



Adi Granth

- 1 The tradition of Punjabi literature can be traced to the **Sufi saint Ganj-i-shakar** (Sufi saint and poet) (12th and 13th Century)

- 2 The teachings and composition of the 10 **Sikh gurus** and other related religious literature form the bulk of the Punjabi literature of the medieval period.
- 3 This includes the Janam-Sakhis (Biographies of gurus), Bachnas (sayings), Paramarthas (commentary on scriptures), Gurbani etc.
- 4 One of the greatest texts of the world is the religious book of the Sikhs- **the Adi Granth** and a majority of it is in Gurmukhi.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

PUNJABI LITERATURE

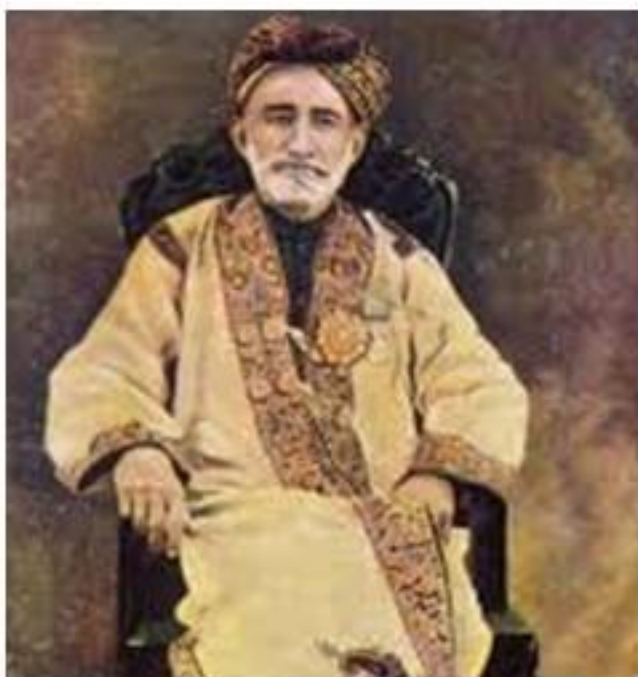


Love story of Heer-Ranjha

- 5 The local literature took heavily to love stories like *Heer-Ranjha* by Waris Shah and *Sohni-Mahiwal* by Fazal Shah.
- 6 Heroic poetry of Punjabi literature includes Vaar which are Punjabi Ballads. *Guru Gobind Singh's Chandi di Vaar* (depicting battles of Goddess Durga with demons) is also an example of epic heroic poetry.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

SINDHI LITERATURE



Mirza Kalish Beg

- 1 The literature in Sindhi has been deeply influenced by the two regions surrounding it: **Rajasthan and Gujarat**.
- 2 As Sindh was always on the border of India, **it was amongst the first to come in contact with Islamic settlers in India**, which also explains the influence of **Islam and Sufism on the poetry**.
- 3 The poetry is very lyrical and meant to be sung.
- 4 Two prominent names in Sindhi Literature are Dewan Kauramal and **Mirza Kalish Beg**.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

URDU LITERATURE



Quli Qutb Shah



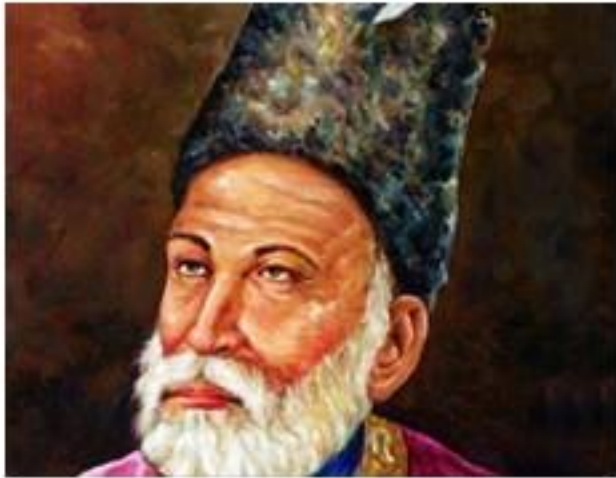
Amir Khusro

- 1 Urdu as a language developed in around 14th century CE as a result of the confluence of the Hindu and Islamic cultures.

- 2 The language derived its vocabulary from Arabic and Persian and also from the Sanskrit based Prakrit.
- 3 The languages mostly follows the grammar of Hindi and the form and script of Persia.
- 4 Amir Khusro was one of the earliest and the greatest influence on the growth of its literature. It also gained from the teachings and composition of Sufi saints such as Khwaja Banda Nawaz Gesu Daraz.
- 5 Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah, ruler of Golconda and a distinguished poet brought secular context to Urdu literature.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

URDU LITERATURE



Mirza Ghalib

- 6 In the 19th century, Bahadur Shah Zafar, the last Mughal emperor was a prominent Urdu poet, while **Mirza Ghalib** is considered to be the greatest of Urdu poets.

- 7 In the 20th century, a major figure in Urdu literary writing was **Iqbal**.

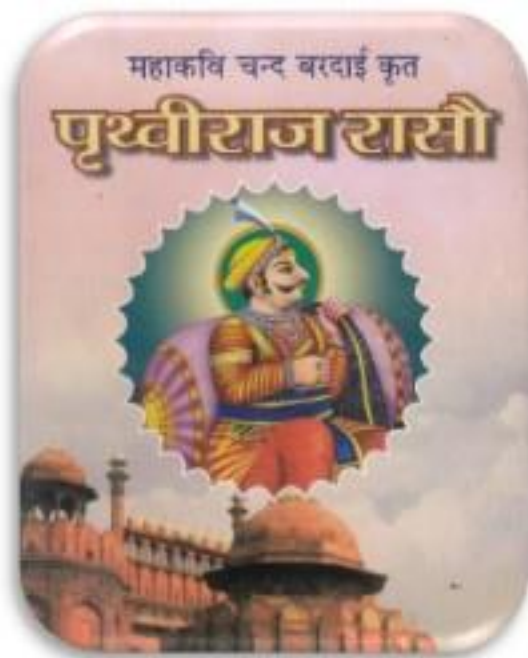
- 8 He is famous for writing “**Saare Jahan Se Achcha**”, which has become a celebrated nationalistic song.

- 9 Apart from the last emperors of the Mughal empire like **Bahadur Shah Zafar**, others like **Nawabs of Awadh** also patronised the same.

- 10 The **Aligarh movement** by **Syed Ahmad Khan** (19th Century) was a prominent influence on Urdu Literature too.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

HINDI LITERATURE

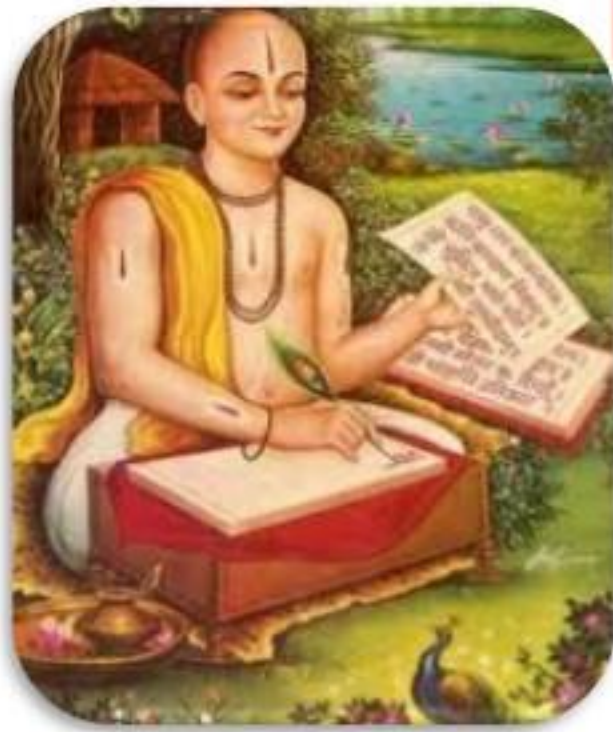


- 1 Hindi as we know it today, evolved between 7th and 14th century from Apabhramsa, which was evolved from Prakrit.

- 2 The language got its biggest boost with the Bhakti movement, which shunned the use of Sanskrit as it was the language of the Brahmins and common people did not use it.
- 3 Hence, they started writing in the language of the people and the twelfth century onwards we see a sharp rise in regional languages like Bengali, Hindi, Marathi, Gujarati, etc.
- 4 For a long time, Hindi literature was in the shadow of its Sanskrit antecedents, but Prithviraj Raso was the first Hindi book and it documents the life and challenges faced by Prithviraj Chauhan.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

HINDI LITERATURE



Tulsidas

- 5 The bulk of the work is poetry by Bhakti writers like Kabir who is famous for his dohas (couplets) that are used by the common people of India even today.

- 6 Tulsidas produced couplets in Braj and was peppered by Persian. He became immortal by writing Ramcharitmanas, one the most revered Hindu texts.

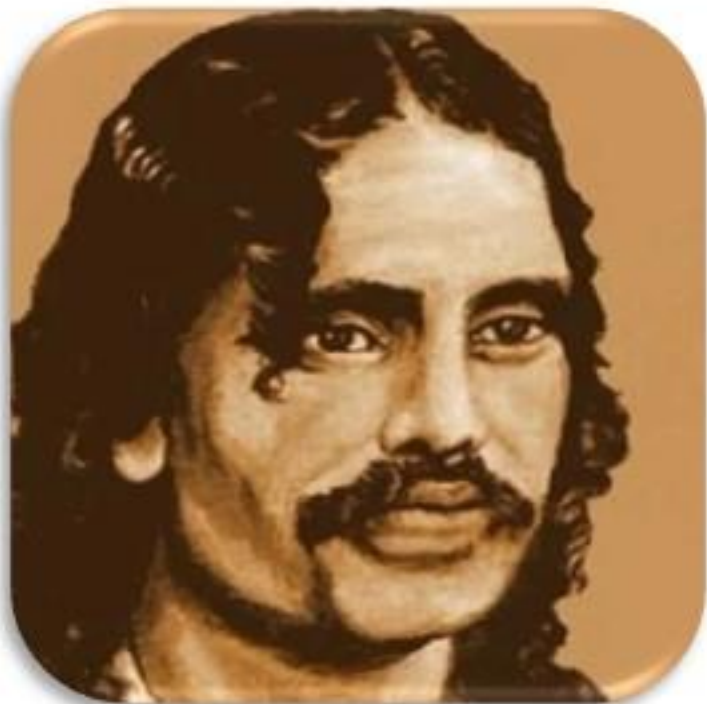
- 7 Lord Krishna's life also became the subject of various medieval poets like Surdas who wrote Sur Sagar about Krishna's infancy and adolescent affairs with the gopis.

- 8 Rahim, Bhushan and Raskhan also wrote about the devotion to Lord Krishna.

- 9 Mirabai is also famous as the woman who renounced the world for Lord Krishna and wrote Bhakti poetry for him.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

HINDI LITERATURE



Bharatendu Harishchandra

- 10** With the coming of the British, the focus of literature changed.

- 11** This change occurred phenomenally in Hindi prose writing where there was a zest to go back to the classics and be inspired by Sanskrit.

- 12** This zest was combined with the **nationalistic fervour**.

- 13** **Bharatendu Harishchandra** wrote his most famous drama **Andher Nagari** (City of Darkness) in 1850s and this became a major play, which has been reproduced several times.

- 14** Another very famous nationalist work is Bharat Durdasha.

REGIONAL LITERATURE

HINDI LITERATURE



Munshi Prem Chand

- 15** The movement to make Hindi the national language, which would link all regions, was spearheaded by **Swami Dayanand**.

- 16** Although he wrote quite a lot in Gujarati, his most famous work in Hindi is **Satyartha Prakash**.

- 17** Several Hindi authors like **Munshi Prem Chand** has contributed significantly. Prem Chand wrote many anthologies in Hindi and Urdu and his famous works include Godan, Bade Bhaiya, etc.

- 18** One of the most famous female writers of Hindi in the twentieth century was **Mahadevi Verma**. She was the **recipient of Padma Vibhushan** in Hindi because of her writing and how it highlighted the condition of women in the society.

COURSE OUTLINE

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|------------|--|-------------|---|
| I | INDIAN ARCHITECTURE
AND SCULPTURE | VII | INDIAN MUSIC |
| II | INDIAN PAINTINGS | VIII | INDIAN RELIGIONS |
| III | INDIAN DANCE FORMS | IX | SCHOOLS OF PHILOSOPHY |
| IV | INDIAN THEATRE | X | CULTURAL
INSTITUTIONS IN INDIA |
| V | INDIAN PUPPETRY | XI | INDIAN LITERATURE |
| VI | MARTIAL ART IN INDIA | | |

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